

Kevin Grieco

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Academic Positions	Institute for Advanced Study in Toulouse (IAST), Research Fellow, September 2025- International Centre for Tax and Development, Pre/Postdoctoral Fellow, 2024-2025
Education	<i>PhD, Political Science, UCLA, 2024</i> Committee: Daniel Posner (co-chair), Darin Christensen (co-chair), Kate Baldwin, Cesi Cruz <i>MS, International Development, Wageningen University, 2016</i> Specialization: Development Economics, <i>Cum Laude</i> <i>BA, Economics & Philosophy, University of New Hampshire, 2012</i>
Working Papers	“Building Fiscal Capacity with Traditional Political Institutions: Evidence from a Field Experiment and Interviews in Sierra Leone” . Job Market Paper . “Participation, Legitimacy and Fiscal Capacity in Weak States: Evidence from Participatory Budgeting,” with Abou Bakarr Kamara, Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, and Wilson Prichard. “Increasing Local Disease Preparedness and Surveillance Capacity for Global Health Security: A Cluster-randomised Control Trial,” with Maarten Voors, Macartan Humphreys, Salif Jaiteh, Mohamed Alpha Jalloh, Sellu Kallon, Niccolò Meriggi, and Peter Van der Windt.
In Preparation	“Property Taxation and Political Accountability: Evidence from a Rule-based Expansion of Tax Demands in Sierra Leone,” with Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, and Wilson Prichard. “Mobilizing Voters with SMS in Sierra Leone,” with Niccolò Meriggi and Maarten Voors. “Signaling Weberianism: Do Governments in Weak States Yield a Fiscal Dividend From Improved Procedural Fairness?” with Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, and Wilson Prichard.
Ongoing Projects	“Credit Access for Responsible Extraction: Providing Incentives to Address Exploitation and Externalities in Sierra Leone’s Artisanal Mining Sector,” with Darin Christensen, Guy Grossman, and Cecilia Mo. “State-building and the Social Contract in Dual Polities: Evidence from Sierra Leone,” with Vanessa van den Boogaard.
External Grants / Fellowships	Total to date: \$1,816,096 2025. IGC, \$7,500 . For Exploring the Socio-Economic Causes and Consequences of ‘Kush’ Abuse Among Young People in Freetown, Sierra Leone, with Henry Mondeh 2024. J-Pal (K-CAI), \$57,860 . For Preserving Mangroves and Livelihoods in Benin, with Darin Christensen and Ambaliou Olounlade 2024. ICTD, \$194,000 . For Traditional Leaders and Formal and Informal Taxation in Sierra Leone, with Vanessa van den Boogaard 2022. Mercatus Center Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship (declined), \$5,000 . For Can Traditional Political Institutions Help the State Raise Property Taxes? 2021. ICTD, \$22,917 . For Can Traditional Political Institutions Help the State Raise Property Taxes? 2021. ICTD, \$5,884 . For Can Rural Property Taxation Generate Revenue? 2021. C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, \$10,000 . 2019. ICTD, \$257,802 . For Compliance, Accountability and the Social Contract, with Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, Wilson Prichard

2019. IGC, **\$25,929**. For Taxation and Political Participation, with Darin Christensen

2019. IGC, **\$25,652**. For Improving Tax Compliance in Freetown, with Derek Holliday and Julian Michel

2018. IGC, **\$110,523**. For Electrifying Growth, with Niccolò Meriggi, Mushfiq Mobarak, and Maarten Voors

2018. UKaid/OPM Energy and Economic Growth, **\$489,688**. For Electrifying Growth, with Niccolò Meriggi, Mushfiq Mobarak, and Maarten Voors

2018. IGC, **\$25,542**. For Improving Tax Systems in Sierra Leone

2018. IGC, **\$10,994**. For Electoral Impacts of Aid, with Niccolò Meriggi and Maarten Voors

2018. IGC, **\$28,165**. For Mobilizing Voters with SMS, with Niccolò Meriggi and Maarten Voors

2018. IGC, **\$12,925**. For Brighter Communities Safer Cities, with Daniel N. Posner

2018. Sustainable Energy Transitions, **\$4,975**. For Brighter Communities Safer Cities.

Internal Grants / Fellowships

2024. UCLA Political Science Department's Swarr Prize (for best unpublished grad paper)

2023. UCLA/Keck Humanistic Inquiry Graduate Research Award, **\$8,000**.

2023. UCLA Fellowship in Political Psychology, **\$1,995**.

2022. UCLA Dissertation Year Fellowship, **\$20,000**.

2022. UCLA Fellowship in Political Psychology, **\$2,000**.

2021. UCLA Summer Mentored Research Fellowship, **\$6,000**.

2021. UCLA Fellowship in Political Psychology, **\$2,000**.

2019. UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Award, **\$6,000**.

2018. UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Award, **\$6,000**.

Talks & Conferences

2026: ECPR Politics of Taxation Joint Sessions; LSE-NYU Political Economy Conference; Science Po-IASST-Oxford Workshop in Political Economy; EPSS

2025: EuroWEPS 12; German Development Economics Conference; EPSA

2024: GLD Workshop (online); WGAP (Accra); World Bank Land Conference; IIPF; APCG Online Colloquium; Public Finance in Developing Countries; CGU Talk Series; UN-Habitat

2023: Governance and Local Development Institute Annual Conference

2022: CaliWEPS V; APSA; Global Development Conference; Sierra Leone Tax Conference

2019: Harvard Experimental Political Science Graduate Conference

Consulting

World Bank, *Consultant*, May 2024–March 2025
Project: [Qualitative Assessment for Institutionalizing the Wan Fambul Framework in Sierra Leone](#)

ICTD, *Consultant*, March 2021–November 2023
Project: [Can Rural Property Taxation Generate Revenue?](#)

Oxford Policy Management, *Consultant*, June 2020–July 2020
Project: [The Role of Traditional Leaders in COVID-19](#)

Oxford Policy Management, *Consultant*, March 2020–May 2020
Project: [A Rapid Assessment of the Response to COVID-19 in Sierra Leone](#)

Service	Referee: <i>Comparative Political Studies; International Tax and Public Finance; Political Research Exchange; Journal of Experimental Political Science; Cogent Economics and Finance</i>	
	Organizer: IAST Conference on Migration, TSE	May 2026
	Organizer: Pieces of the Craft Workshop Series, UCLA	2018-2019
	Convener: Comparative Politics Reading Group, UCLA	2018-2019
Teaching	<i>Teaching Assistant, UCLA</i>	
	Introduction to Comparative Politics (undergraduate)	2018, 2021, 2023
	Foundations and Debates in Public Thought (undergraduate)	2022
	<i>Guest Lecturer</i>	
	Public Finance in Developing Countries, University of Oxford (graduate)	March, 2024
Skills/ Experience	<i>Languages:</i> English (Native), Sierra Leone Krio (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate)	
	<i>Fieldwork:</i> Sierra Leone (4+ years); Benin	
	<i>Research Director:</i> Baobab, data collection NGO registered in Freetown, Sierra Leone	
References	Daniel N. Posner	
	Professor of Political Science	University of California, Los Angeles ✉ dposner@polisci.ucla.edu
	Darin Christensen	
	Associate Professor of Public Policy & Political Science	University of California, Los Angeles ✉ darinc@luskin.ucla.edu
	Kate Baldwin	
	Associate Political Science & Global Affairs	Yale University ✉ kate.baldwin@yale.edu